

# The Boston Globe

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## ICE raid in Vt. turns into violent confrontation

Agents' tactics condemned while actions of state and local police are questioned

By Paul Heintz  
GLOBE STAFF

SOUTH BURLINGTON, Vt. — A furious round of finger pointing and condemnation erupted in Vermont on Thursday over the first major skirmish in the state on the Trump administration's immigration policies, a raid by federal agents that went awry and culminated in a violent melee involving protesters and local police.

Vermont officials condemned the tactics of federal agents, while activists questioned why state and local police played a supporting role that they claimed violated policies meant to curb cooperation with federal immigration authorities.

Many called for investigations into the chaotic event, though they did not agree on who should do the investigating, or even who should be investigated.

Meanwhile, new details emerged about the day-long skirmish, which included a lengthy standoff outside a residence in South Burlington, the detention of three undocumented immigrants, none of whom were the original target, and the use of pepper spray and flashbang devices for crowd control.

Local and state police said the incident began around 7:30 a.m. Wednesday, when US Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents

►Teen detained by ICE in Marlborough parking lot is reunited with family. B1.

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## Watching over path of most resistance

Nantucket walk that pits visitors vs. homeowners gets 'docent' to keep tabs

By Shannon Larson  
GLOBE STAFF

Fights over access to waterfront and coastlines in New England are a constant. But the folks in Nantucket have taken theirs to a new level: hiring a "docent" to monitor the crowds that will inevitably swarm the Sconset Bluff Walk in summer.

The unusual step is the result of long-simmering tensions over public use of the winding dirt trail along a scenic bluff that overlooks the ocean and is near a string of multimillion-dollar properties.

Located on the east coast of the island well away from the bustle of downtown Nantucket, the trail ranges from a narrow walkway only a few feet from a cluster of old-timey cottages, to a more open section by pristine lawns within clear view of homeowners, before slowly rising to the top of the bluff that offers sweeping views of beach and sand flats.

Modest in scale, the path has increasingly become a destination for visitors, its popularity boosted by social media buzz. The civic association estimates that more than 1,000 people a day use the walk during July and August.

"It is a problem," said actor and director

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'It felt quite hopeless — like quite a few times.'

CAITLIN DROWN, a Cape Cod native who was in Dubai

## Far from Mass., caught in war's chaos

Stranded travelers scramble to find way out of Mideast

By Jackie Kucinich  
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Brockett Horne, a professor from Boston, had just arrived in Abu Dhabi on Feb. 28 and was in line at customs when a text alert shrieked from her phone and others around her: It was a message from the UAE, in English and in

Arabic, that urged people to shelter in place.

"It was kind of like a shock to be standing there, waiting to get checked into the country, and for that to come through," she recounted of being in the Gulf on the first day of the US bombing of nearby Iran.

Meanwhile in Dubai, Caitlin Drown and her partner had just settled into their hotel room for her first vacation since moving to London last summer, when they suddenly found themselves scrambling to leave.

"Unfortunately, it was a couple

hours after we landed that the airstrikes happened," Drown, a Cape Cod native, said. "We were actually sleeping, trying to catch up after taking a red eye, and then woke up to the news about airstrikes."

►New Iranian supreme leader strikes a defiant tone. A4.

Horne and Drown are just two of the tens of thousands of Americans who were stranded in the Middle East after the US-Israeli attack on Iran, and subsequent counter-at-

tacks, plunged the region into chaos. With so many flights abruptly canceled, the State Department initially offered few options to Americans trying to escape, leaving them on their own. Many turned to their congressional representatives for help, leaving lawmakers wondering why a US-initiated war left Americans in the region with so little help to get home.

Drown, 34, who works in communications, immediately began searching online. Initially, the lack of information for Americans was daunting,

ESCAPE, Page A5

## AN AMERICAN DREAM



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Amelia Charles from Romania took a photo of herself and her husband, Ray, and their 17-month-old daughter, Bella, after Charles was sworn in as a US citizen during a naturalization ceremony in Boston on Thursday.

## Feeling the squeeze, cities say it's either more funding or big cuts

By Niki Griswold  
GLOBE STAFF

Amesbury eliminated all foreign language classes at the city's middle school last year. Chelsea officials are debating whether the city can afford to keep staffing a fourth fire engine they bought less than two years ago. Boston Public Schools leaders are weighing cuts of up to 400 teachers and other staff.

Even as property taxes spike in many cities and towns, local officials across Massachusetts say they're being forced to consider painful budget decisions — and asking voters to do the same

— just so they can meet the rising costs of basic services. Without state intervention, they warn, the cuts will keep coming.

Local leaders are pleading with state lawmakers to make changes to what they say is a broken funding system. Among the asks: increases in local state aid and more flexibility in how they tax residents.

But the state has its own fiscal constraints, in part due to federal funding reductions and political pressure to ease Massachusetts' high cost of living. That's left municipal leaders' proposals — and their budgets —

facing an uncertain future.

Northampton Mayor Gina-Louise Sciarra said she has already had to cut positions in schools and trim back public works services. It's meant the city is slower to fill potholes and plow streets after snowstorms than residents would like, and has had to add back paraprofessional positions that it previously lost after increasing their numbers during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Sciarra said the school district has also struggled to keep up with rising special education

FUNDING, Page A8

Proposition 2½ caps increases to the total amount municipalities collect in property taxes by **2.5%** each year, with some exceptions.

Several local officials said their health insurance costs alone are growing **8% to 12%** a year.

**ROTC students killed a gunman who yelled "Allahu Akbar" before opening fire** in an Old Dominion University classroom, killing one person and wounding two. **A2.**

**An attacker armed with a rifle rammed his vehicle** into one of the nation's largest reform synagogues. **A2.**

**Robert Kraft can't salvage Boston's World Cup ambitions all by himself**, writes Shirley Leung. **B5.**

**China adopted a sweeping law to promote what it calls "ethnic unity,"** a measure that critics say would further erode the rights of some minority groups. **A3.**



### Marching along

**Friday:** Sun, then showers. High 41-46. Low 36-41.

**Saturday:** Some sun, breezy. High 46-51. Low 26-31.

Sunrise: 7:00 Sunset: 6:48  
**Weather and Comics, G6-7.**

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## State goes big on early college as a way to cut student costs

Edward Coelho, a Framingham High School senior, takes classes at Framingham State University to earn credits. He also volunteers to help others who aren't sure if college is right for them.



TAYLOR COESTER FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

By Hilary Burns  
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts leaders believe they have found an answer to the problem of students forgoing higher education because of the cost — help thousands of high school students graduate with college credits for free.

Early college has been around for about nine years, but state leaders are realizing just how effective it has been at both reducing tuition for families and launching students who might not otherwise go to college, so Governor Maura Healey is doubling down.

Healey announced in her State of the Commonwealth address her ambitions to grow the state's early college program to 100,000 students within 10 years, up from about 10,000 participants in the

current academic year.

"We want to make sure that all students have access to a great college experience, if they so choose, and we also know that for too long, money's been a barrier," Healey said in an interview this week. "We know from studies that students who've done early college have a greater persistence rate — that is, staying in college once they start."

The state says the program is working so far, with about 66 percent of high school graduates who took college courses immediately enrolling in higher education, and about 82 percent of students returning for a second year. Students from middle-income as well as wealthy families can also participate in the program at no cost.

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